



The Souled Store

A Case Study in Fandom-Driven D2C Growth

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Brand Introduction

What is The Souled Store?

India's leading pop culture merchandise D2C brand — officially licensed apparel and lifestyle products built on authentic fandom, launched in **June 2013** from a small apartment in Mumbai Central with just **₹5.25 lakh** in founder savings.

❏ "We saw an opportunity to build a brand that combined authentic licensed fandom with high-quality apparel that people could wear every day."

₹700 Cr
Revenue FY26

2.1M
Instagram Followers

5M+
App Downloads

22+
Retail Stores

Current Scale (FY26)

USP: Authentic licenses (Marvel, DC, Disney, anime) + superior print quality + affordable pricing + community-driven approach.



Problem Statement

The Market Gap (2013)

India's pop culture merchandise market was **completely unorganized** — fans had nowhere to turn for authentic, affordable, locally-available licensed products.

Current Challenges

→ Intense Competition

Bewakoof, Redwolf, and international players fighting for the same fandom-first consumer.

→ Quality at Scale

Maintaining print quality and durability as monthly order volumes cross 2.5 Lakh units.

→ Omnichannel Profitability

Balancing online growth with 22+ retail stores while keeping CAC in check.

Expensive Imports

Fans forced to buy costly US merchandise with long wait times and high shipping costs.

Counterfeit Flood

Poor quality fake products dominated the market with no quality guarantee.

Zero Emotional Connect

No authentic Indian brand building a community around fandom culture.

Target Audience & Buyer Persona

Primary Audience

Age

18–34 years (core: 18–24)

Gender

50% Male / 50% Female

Location

Tier 1 & 2 cities — Mumbai, Delhi, Bangalore, Hyderabad, Pune

Income

₹3–10 Lakh annual household income

Buyer Persona: "Fandom Enthusiast Aditya"

24-year-old software engineer.

Marvel fan. Anime enthusiast. Gamer.

- Active on Instagram & YouTube — follows pop culture trends closely
- Seeks self-expression through fashion; tired of generic clothing
- Values authentic merchandise that reflects identity and community belonging
- **Purchase frequency:** 4–6 orders/year at ₹1,500–2,500 AOV

❑ Aditya doesn't just buy a t-shirt. He buys a piece of the story he loves.



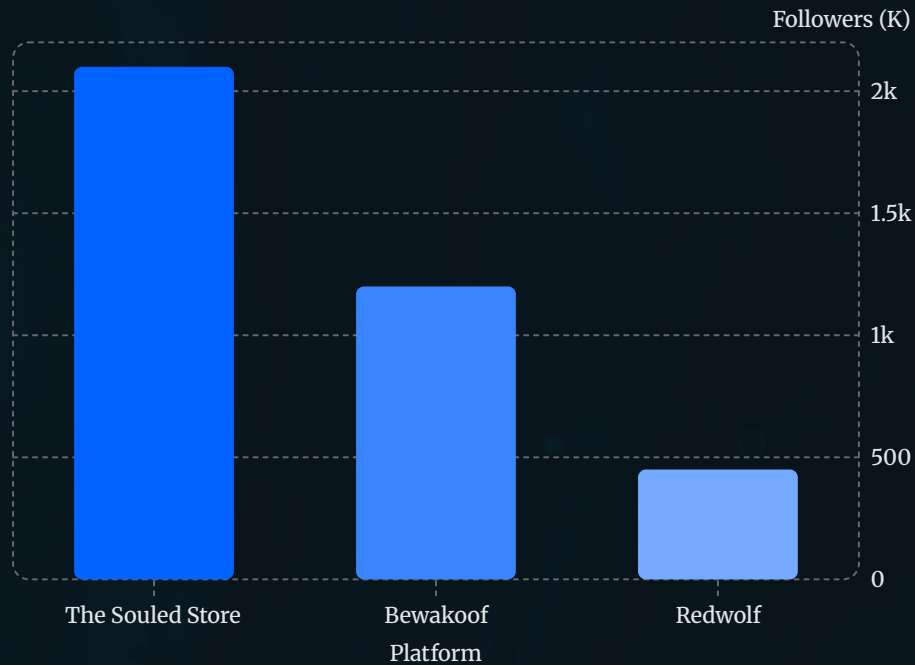
Competitor Analysis

The Souled Store leads India’s pop culture merchandise space — outpacing rivals on revenue, reach, and community engagement.

Metric	The Souled Store	Bewakoof	Redwolf
Founded	2013	2012	2011
Revenue	₹700 Cr (FY26)	₹250+ Cr	₹40 Cr
Instagram	2.1M followers	1.2M followers	450K followers
Positioning	Licensed pop culture	Affordable casual wear	Indie graphic tees
Price Range	₹499–2,999	₹299–1,499	₹599–2,499
Key Strength	Official licenses + community	Price + variety	Design authenticity

Competitive Advantage: Official licensing partnerships, superior print quality, and the strongest community engagement in the category — factors competitors struggle to replicate.

Current Digital Presence Audit



Instagram (@thesouledstore)

- **2.1M followers** — ranked 46th among streetwear creators globally
- **8,631 posts** with a consistent, high-cadence content strategy
- **1.69% engagement rate** — 21,104 avg likes per post
- Content mix: product showcases, Reels, Stories, collabs & UGC

Website, App & Retail

- **5M+ app downloads** — mobile-first consumer strategy
- **2.5 Lakh orders/month** shipped, processing time cut from 24 to 12 hours
- Marketplace presence on Flipkart, Myntra & Amazon
- **22+ physical stores** enabling full omnichannel integration

Content Strategy & Campaign Idea

Content Pillars



Fandom Celebrations

New movie/show releases, character anniversaries, franchise milestones.



Community Stories

Customer testimonials, fan art features, "Why I Love" series.



Product Launches

Exclusive drops, limited editions, creator/celebrity collabs.



Behind-the-Scenes

Design process, printing techniques, team stories.

Campaign: "Multiverse of Fandom"

Hook: "Your favorite characters, your favorite store, your favorite community."

Concept: Celebrate the full diversity of fandoms — Marvel, DC, anime, Bollywood, gaming — united under one brand identity.

- **Platforms:** Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts, TikTok, Pinterest
- **Formats:** 15–30 sec videos, carousels, interactive stories, UGC contests
- **Frequency:** 5–7 posts/week across all platforms



The "Multiverse" metaphor mirrors the brand's core identity — one world, infinite fandoms.

Content Calendar & Ad Creatives

7-Day Content Calendar (Sept 23–30)

Date	Platform	Format	Description
Sept 23	Instagram	Reel	New Marvel collection launch teaser
Sept 24	Instagram	Carousel	5 styling tips with new collection
Sept 25	YouTube	Short	Behind-the-scenes: Design process
Sept 26	Instagram	Story Series	Customer testimonials (3–4 stories)
Sept 27	TikTok	Trend Video	Trending audio + product showcase
Sept 28	Instagram	Reel	Fan art feature + giveaway announcement
Sept 29	Pinterest	Pin	Seasonal outfit inspiration board
Sept 30	Instagram	Carousel	Week recap + top performing posts

Ad Creative Concepts



Marvel Launch

"Your Hero. Your Style. New Marvel collection is LIVE. Limited edition drops. Shop now."
#MarvelFans #LimitedEdition #TheSouledStore



Community Collage

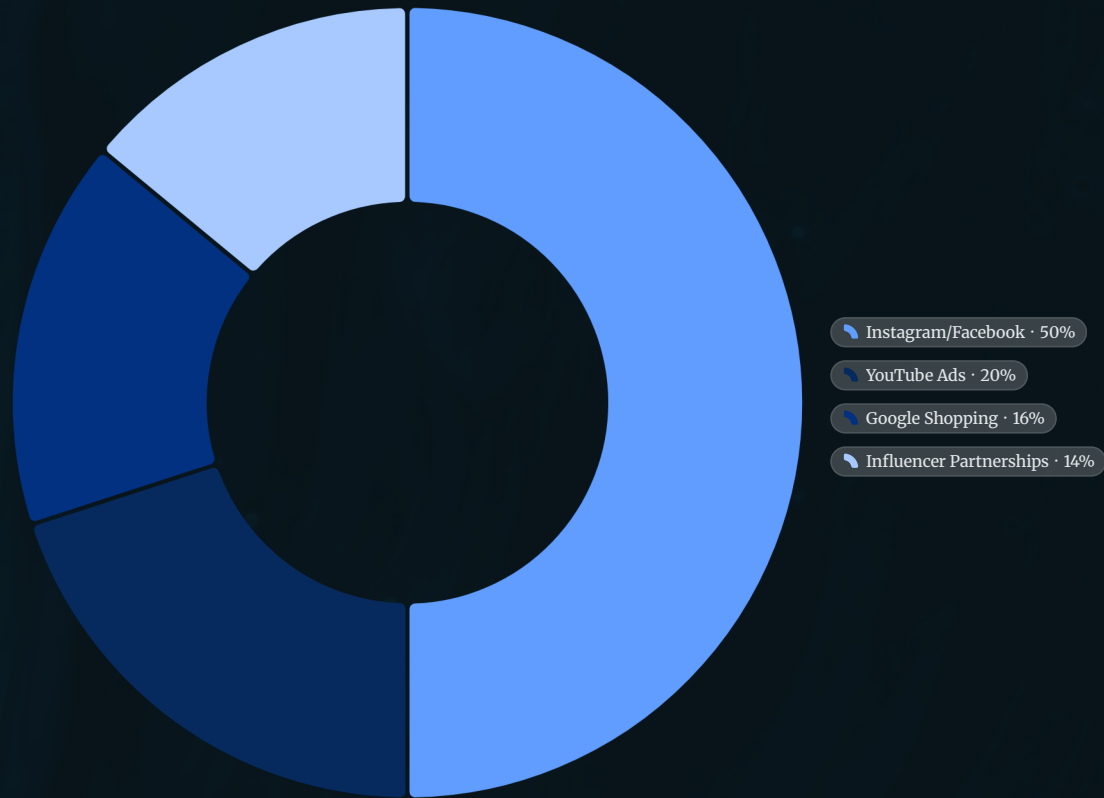
"This is the Multiverse of Fandom. Every soul, every story, every style. Tag yourself! 🗣️"
#CommunityLove #FandomFamily



Flash Sale

"48 HOURS ONLY. Get 30% off on anime collection. Use code: MULTIVERSE30"
#FlashSale #AnimeLovers #ShopNow

Paid Strategy



Monthly Budget: ₹50 Lakh

Audience Targeting

- Primary: Ages 18–34, interests in Marvel, DC, anime, gaming, pop culture
- Secondary: Lookalike audiences from website visitors & app users
- Retargeting: Cart abandoners, past customers, website visitors
- Geographic: Delhi, Mumbai, Bangalore, Hyderabad, Pune, Chennai

Bidding & Expected Results (30-Day)

2.5Cr
Impressions

15:1

Target ROAS

Bid Type: Target CPA — ₹800–1,200 per purchase | Frequency Cap: 3–5 impressions/user/day

50K
Conversions

₹7.5Cr

Revenue

Key Takeaways & Strategic Recommendations

Double Down on Licensing

Exclusive franchise partnerships remain the single most defensible moat. Expand anime and gaming IP deals to capture next-gen fandoms.

Community Is the Moat

1.69% engagement across 2.1M followers signals genuine community. Invest in UGC campaigns and fan-first events to deepen loyalty.

Omnichannel = Competitive Edge

22+ stores + 5M+ app downloads + marketplace presence creates a flywheel competitors cannot replicate on price alone.

"Multiverse of Fandom" Campaign

Execute the 7-day content calendar with 15:1 ROAS target. ₹50L/month paid budget optimized across Instagram, YouTube, Google & influencers.

- ❑ The Souled Store's ₹700 Cr journey from a ₹5.25 lakh apartment startup proves that authentic community-led growth beats generic fashion at scale — every time.